

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

It's good to catch up after so long!



Learning Outcome

Exchange information about people's interests and backgrounds using a wider range of language.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about socializing.
- I can talk about life experiences.
- I can express possibility or certainty.

Ask your partner:

- What do you like to do to relieve stress? Why?
- Do you think that practicing a sport is a good way to make friends? Why or why not?





Let's Explore!

Matt's date is **stuck*** in traffic. Let's hope she's not too late!

* When you're "stuck" in a situation, it's very difficult to get out of that situation.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Peter:** Look at the time! Do you think Cathy may have forgotten you guys had a date?
- Matt:** Cathy must be on her way. She may be late because of rush hour, though.
- Peter:** I'm not complaining. It's good to catch up after so long.
- Matt:** For sure! I had thought about calling you a couple of days before I met Cathy again. I must have forgotten to. I've been spending most of my evenings at the gym lately!
- Peter:** That's alright, buddy. You're making me feel out of shape, that's all.
- Matt:** You could definitely get back in shape in no time if you stick around with us!
- Peter:** I'm afraid I might tear a muscle! I had thought of joining you guys for a game a few months ago, just before I injured my hamstring in a bike accident.
- Matt:** Oh yeah! I remember that. It took you a few weeks to heal completely. It must have hurt!
- Peter:** It wasn't that bad, actually. A colleague of mine had fallen off his bike the week before I did, and he broke both his ankles! The doctors told him that he may not be able to walk properly for a while ...
- Matt:** That's too bad. I certainly wouldn't know what to do without regular physical activity. I hadn't realized how good it was for relieving stress until I started going to the gym every day.
- Peter:** I know. It releases endorphins in the brain, which is what makes you feel happy. I could definitely use some of those at the moment!





Let's Practice!

Matt is talking to Peter about Cathy and their routine at the gym.

Instructions: Read the contextualization sentence. Select the answer that best describes what Matt means. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. Cathy must be on her way, she must be late because of rush hour. What does Matt say?
 - a. Matt is sure Cathy is not coming.
 - b. Matt thinks Cathy is late due to the traffic.
 - c. Matt says Cathy may arrive in two hours.
2. You could definitely get back in shape in no time if you stick around with us. What does Matt say?
 - a. Matt thinks that Peter can get fit easily.
 - b. Matt thinks that Peter is lazy.
 - c. Matt thinks that Peter should have more friends.
3. I hadn't realized how good it was for relieving stress, until I started going to the gym every day. What does Matt say?
 - a. Matt thinks going to the gym is a waste of time.
 - b. Matt says going to the gym is stressful.
 - c. Matt says going to the gym is the best.



Let's Practice!

I know this new place downtown. It's fun!

Instructions: Fill in the gaps using the words from the Word Bank. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. It's good to _____ after so long.
2. I wanted to call you, but I tore a _____ and was at the hospital.
3. If we go dancing, we will also release some _____, which is very good.
4. I'm so happy we could reunite again, though seeing you makes me feel _____.
5. Don't worry, we will have enough time _____ some stress and do some sports.

Word Bank

- to release
- endorphins
- catch up
- out of shape
- hamstring



Extension Activity

Write a report on what people do to relieve stress.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Interview 8 to 10 people about the way they relieve stress.
- For each person, ask a few questions about the activity they chose, how often they practice it, and whether it is always effective.
- Write a report (8-10 lines) about your findings.
- Present your report to a partner.
- Listen to your partner's report and discuss the differences and similarities.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I identify activities to relieve stress.

☐ ☐

I talk about certainty and possibility.

☐ ☐

I discuss differences and similarities with my partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **out of shape** (expression): in bad physical condition
e.g. You're making me feel out of shape, that's all.
- **to tear** (verb): to pull apart or into pieces by force
e.g. I'm afraid I might tear a muscle!
- **hamstring** (noun): a tendon behind your knee
e.g. I injured my hamstring in a bike accident.
- **to release** (verb): to liberate something or someone
e.g. It releases chemicals in the brain, which is what makes you feel happy.
- **to relieve** (verb): to free from pain, anxiety, or distress
e.g. I hadn't realized how good it was for relieving stress.
- **endorphins** (noun): natural painkillers liberated by the body when performing physical activity
e.g. Physical activity releases endorphins in the brain.





Learning Points

The Past Perfect Tense

You use the Past Perfect tense to identify and talk about an 'earlier past'.

When you are talking about a past event, you can refer to something that happened at an earlier time to that past event by using the Past Perfect tense.

The structure of the Past Perfect is:

Subject + had + past participle

*A colleague of mine **had fallen off** his bike the week before I did.*

Which event happened *first*? A colleague fell off his bike.

Which event happened *later*? I fell off my bike.

You use the Past Perfect tense (not Simple Past) when you want to talk about how long something had continued **up to a past moment**.

Example:

I hadn't realized how good it was for relieving stress until I started going to the gym every day.

Examples:

- *I had thought about calling you a couple of days before I met Cathy again.*
- *I had thought of joining you guys for a game a few months ago, just before I injured my hamstring in a bike accident.*





Learning Points

Modals for Possibility and Certainty

You can use modals to talk about degrees of certainty.

You use them to describe what is definite, probable, possible, or impossible from the speaker's point of view.

You can use *must*, *may*, *might*, and *could* to describe degrees of certainty.

You can use modals with the Present Perfect to talk about the possibility of a past event that is not clear in the present context.

Example:

It must have hurt.

Must = it's very likely

Must not / Could not / Can't = it's not possible

May / Might / Can / Could = it's possible

May not / Might not = it's possible this is not true

Modal	Meaning
<i>It must have hurt!</i>	It's very likely that it hurts.
<i>You could definitely get back in shape.</i>	It's possible for you to get back in shape.
<i>He may not be able to walk properly for a while ...</i>	It's not likely that he can walk properly for a while.

